

The Relationship of Jeevan and Brain: The Perspective of Madhyasth Darshan

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Abstract

This research paper explores the relationship between jeevan and the brain on the basis of Madhyasth Darshan, serving as a bridge between modern science and traditional *darshanas*. It involves a comparative study and analysis of the foundational works authored by Shri A. Nagraj, the originator of Madhyasth Darshan. An organised classification is presented to clarify the concepts of jeevan, consciousness, and the brain.

The study establishes that jeevan is a sentient entity — a constitutionally complete atom — which is the composite form of *mun*, *vriddhi*, *chitta*, *buddhi*, and *atma*. The brain is identified as a physicochemical nervous system functioning under the guidance of jeevan. The entirety of existence is categorised into eight distinct stages — from the material order to the completely awakened human.

This study, for the first time, presents the relationship between jeevan and the brain in a systematic manner, demonstrating a correlation between the materialist outlook of science and the sentience-based conception of traditional darshanas.

The research further aids in understanding the three stages of human development — partially awakened, half-awakened, and awakened/completely awakened — and paves the way for both individual and social progress.

Keywords: Madhyasth Darshan, Jeevan, Brain, Consciousness, Awakening, Co-existentialism, Knowledge order, Animal order.

Introduction

1. Science – The Concept of Brain

Science acknowledges that from insects to humans, all possess a complete central nervous control system through which the body is regulated (Bullock & Horridge, 1965; Strausfeld, 2012; Kandel, Schwartz, & Jessell, 2013; Shepherd, 2016). It has been demonstrated that even in invertebrates, a well-organised central nervous system is present (Bullock & Horridge, 1965).

The work *Arthropod Brains: Evolution, Functional Elegance, and Historical Significance* shows that in arthropods (such as insects and spiders), brain-like structures are also developed. *Principles of Neural Science* — a foundational text of modern neuroscience — presents a comparative study of nervous systems from insects to humans (Kandel, Schwartz, & Jessell, 2013). Likewise, *Neurobiology* (5th ed.) provides a detailed exposition of the physiology of central nervous systems in both vertebrates and invertebrates. Thus, the scientific perspective becomes clear.

Madhyasth Darshan (originator: Shree A. Nagaraj) also affirms that the activities in insects are regulated through the brain. In them, functions such as eating, sleeping, defending, and mating are apparent, which indicate the mutual relationship between body and brain. (There is no controller of the brain in these cases.)

The entities of the material order and biological order are without brains, whereas the entities of the animal order and knowledge order are endowed with brains. (Manav Vyavhar Darshan, p. 34)

2. Plants and the Concept of Jeevan

From the perspective of religious and idealistic studies, it is often assumed that plants too have life. Science does accept them as “living,” yet a linguistic and conceptual confusion arises here, because the terms life, living, and consciousness are frequently used interchangeably (Cleland & Chyba, 2002; Trewavas, 2014; Chamovitz, 2012; Nagel, 1974; Nagaraj, 2004).

Madhyasth Darshan makes it necessary to clarify that “sentience” is not a part or property of the body, but an independent entity— a point that is made especially clear in various expositions of Madhyasth Darshan. On this subject, differences of opinion still persist within the scientific community as well as among psychologists.

3. The Real Definition of Jeevan: According to Madhyasth Darshan

Unlike religious, idealistic, and scientific perspectives, Madhyasth Darshan explains that “jeevan” is not a physical or physico-chemical entity, but a sentient entity which provides humans with the capacities for thought, decision-making, and realisation.

Jeevan is a constitutionally complete atom. It is free from all kinds of physical and chemical activities (weight bondage and molecular bondage); therefore, it is perennial and immortal. This jeevan is composed of five inseparable parts: *mun*, *vriddhi*, *chitta*, *buddhi*, and *atma*. (Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad)

This jeevan can exist in four states:

Unawakened: In the animal order.

Partially awakened: When jeevan remains influenced by the body (brain). It remains unhappy due to this, but seeks freedom from this pain.

Half awakened: When the inquiry for understanding truth begins in jeevan, and it performs all activities while taking this as its goal.

Awakened/Completely awakened: When jeevan, with complete understanding, controls the body through the brain, participates in orderliness, and becomes its source.

In the animal order, *mun* functions according to species-conformance, keeping the body alive with the hope of living. Thus, it is referred to as "unawakened". The intellectual aspect is undeveloped in the animal order. In that status - *mun* is regulated by the body, while *vriddhi* and *chitta* remain neglected. (Manav Vyavhar Darshan - p 140)

In the knowledge order, *buddhi* is apparent in three statuses:

Partially developed (partially awakened): The desire-based tendency of thought and hope in jeevan is referred to as partially awakened. In this status - *mun* and *vriddhi* are driven by *chitta*.

Half developed (half awakened): The resolve (definitive understanding) devoid of enlightenment of *atma* based tendency of desire, thought and hope is referred to as half awakened. In this status - *mun*, *vriddhi* and *chitta* are driven by *buddhi*.

Developed (awakened - completely awakened): The tendency of desire, thought, and hope based on resolve with enlightenment of *atma*, is referred to

as awakened. In this status - *mun*, *vritti*, *chitta* and *buddhi* are regulated and disciplined by *atma*. (Manav Vyavhar Darshan - p 141)

3. The classification for understanding the relationship of jeevan and brain: Entire existence can be seen in the following 8 stages.

1. Presence of Activity, but no Respiration, Brain or Jeevan:

For example: Insentient matter - soil, rocks, water, air, etc.

2. Presence of Activity and Respiration, but no Brain or Jeevan:

For example: trees and plants (they have life, but there is no central control)

(The expression of imaginativeness and freedom in action is due to jeevan and not due to the body.)

The body is composed only of the substance and activity of biological order. The whole body composition is made of biological cells. (Manav Karma Darshan, 2004, p 162)

Every biological cell is found with *pran sutras*. These *pran sutras* have definite measures of *rachna tatva* and *pushti tatva*. Such *pran sutras* have respiration activity in them. (Manav Karma Darshan, 2004, p 112)

The entities of the material order and biological order do not have brains, while those of the animal order and knowledge order have brains. (Manav Vyavhar Darshan, p 34)

3. Presence of Activity, Respiration and Brain, but no Jeevan.

For example - insects; All these organisms are driven from the brain. Jeevan is not present in them.

The bodies of animal-selves are also composed of biological cells. These compositions include a special part as the brain, which is not found in the biological order. (Manav Anubhav Darshan, 2004, p 36)

Bodies in which all five sense organs function by virtue of their union with jeevan can be recognised as possessing a developed brain. Apart from these, all other kinds of formations are clearly spontaneously generated. (Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad, 2009, p 213-214)

When the biological order itself becomes enriched, the emergence of the animal order begins through the method of spontaneous generation. In the spontaneously generated world, certain beings or forms have been observed to transform into the oviparous lineage. For example, the scorpion is naturally formed through spontaneous generation, yet it manifests the oviparous system. Other such possibilities have also unfolded. (Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad, 2009, p 189-190)

The spontaneously generated and underdeveloped brain-endowed organisms are not governed by *jeevan*, nor are they governable. (Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad, 2009, p 299)

4. The Presence of Activity, Respiration, Developed Brain, and Jeevan.

For example, cow, elephant etc; here jeevan works according to the body (brain), and it has been called species-conforming. The jeevan is unawakened here.

The existence of jeevan is established in organisms whose body is composed of the seven elements, whose brain system is well-developed, and who possess the capacity to receive the directives of a human. (Page 112, Manav Karma Darshan, 2004)

On this basis, in some organisms, the body came to be composed of the seven elements and endowed with the most developed brain structure. (Page 107, Manav Karma Darshan, 2004)

When the animal body is formed with a fully developed brain, it is then directed by jeevan. Only in such bodies are the activities of the seven elements seen to be carried out with mutual coordination. The seven elements are: 1. Rasa (plasma), 2. Māns (muscle), 3. Majjā (marrow), 4. Rakta (blood), 5. Snāyu (tendons/nerves), 6. Haḍḍi (bone), and 7. Vasā (fat). (Page 213, Samadhanatmak Bhautikvad, 2009)

5. The Presence of Activity, Respiration, Fully developed brain, and Jeevan is deluded.

Example, Partially awakened human; Jeevan is affected by the body, imaginativeness gets expressed, but its point of satisfaction is not there. Jeevan suffers from this, and wants to be liberated from this situation.

The most developed organism is the brain in the human body. The human body only has the most developed brain. (Manav Vyavhar Darshan, 2011, p 41)

The human body is the most highly developed structure because the brain in the human body has attained complete development. (Page 64, Manav Karma Darshan, 2004)

6. The Presence of Activity, Respiration, Fully-developed Brain, and Jeevan has become completely resolved for Awakening.

Which is called a half-awakened human.

7. Where Jeevan with complete understanding drives the body through the brain and presents the evidence of understanding in their behaviour and system.

They are awakened humans.

8. Here Jeevan participates in behaviour and system with complete understanding, and evidences this understanding in education and health-discipline system (as a point of satisfaction of freedom in action).

And becomes the source of awakening for other people. They become the bearers and carriers of education sanskar.

Realisation, evidence, and enlightenment are communicated through the nervous system, and this happens only in the human tradition. (Manav Vyavhar Darshan, p 48, 2011)

From the sequence of all these structures and from the study of the human body, it is evident that in the human body the enrichment of the brain has become completely accomplished. The proof of this is that the human body through the brain is a capable unit for jeevan to express imaginativeness, freedom in action, and their fulfillment — in the form of knowing, believing, recognising, and fulfilling. (Page 62, Manav Karm Darshan, 2004)

The Main Division

Classification	Natural Orders	Specialities
The world without brain	Material Order (1), Biological Order (2)	Communication of realisation, evidence, enlightenment is not possible.
The world with brain	Animal Order (3-4). Knowledge Order (5-8)	Communication of realisation, evidence, enlightenment is possible through the nervous system.

The Tabular Form of Orders:

SN	Order	Activity	Respiration	Brain	Developed Brain	Fully Developed Brain	Partially Awakened	Half Awakened	Awakened	Completely Awakened
1	Material Order	✓								
2	Biological Order	✓	✓							
3	Animal Order (without jeevan)	✓	✓	✓						
4	Animal Order (with jeevan)	✓	✓		✓					
5	Knowledge Order (Deluded/Partially Awakened)	✓	✓			✓	✓			
6	Knowledge Order (Resolved for Awakening)	✓	✓			✓		✓		
7	Knowledge Order (Complete Understanding)	✓	✓			✓			✓	
8	Knowledge Order (with evidence)	✓	✓			✓				✓

Conclusion

This study in Madhyasth Darshan makes it clear that the relationship between jeevan and the brain is both subtle and profound. The main conclusions are as follows:

Key Points:

- Jeevan is a conscious entity, distinct from the physical body.
- The brain is a physical system that functions under the direction of jeevan.
- From matter to the fully awakened human, there are eight distinct stages of development.
- The presence of a fully developed brain in humans makes them unique.

Practical Understanding:

In the animal order, jeevan is controlled by the brain, whereas in the knowledge order, jeevan controls the brain. This distinction sets humans apart from other organisms and enables imaginativeness, freedom in action , and the pursuit of fulfillment.

Future Direction:

The journey from partially awakened to completely awakened is the real trajectory of human development, in which jeevan recognises its complete potential and becomes the source of orderliness.

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